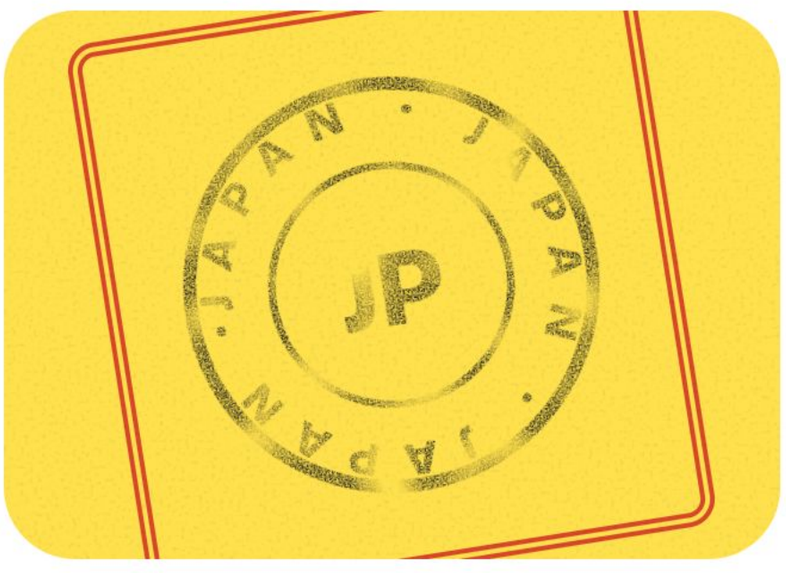
Running a creative review in Japan





Aidan McFarlane

aidanmdesign.xyz

Nemawashi, before the meeting



One by one

Share the work with key people early

Listen

Hear concerns privately, then adjust

No surprises

Nobody senior sees it first in the room

Aidan McFarlane **aidanmdesign.xyz**

What they say, what it means



They say	It usually means
持ち帰って検討します	We'll consider it internally
面白いですね	Interesting, not yet a yes
前向きに検討します	Positive, still needs approval

Aidan McFarlane aidanmdesign.xyz

Don’t push for a yes

Decisions are made after the meeting, not in it.

Send minutes the same day and follow the approval.

Minutes sent the same day

“Can we sign off now?”



Aidan McFarlane aidanmdesign.xyz

In Japan, the review confirms what was agreed before it.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

Aidan McFarlane
aidanmdesign.xyz

